

The Proof Layer, Drawn

Written for two readers: the partner who will build it, and the security reviewer at a customer who has to sign it off. It takes every drawing in the technology overview one level deeper, and it says where it stops.

9	6	7	4
LAYERS, AND WHO BUILDS EACH	PLACES TWO PARTS TOUCH	THINGS THE EVIDENCE STORE HOLDS	THINGS THAT CANNOT BE ADDED LATER

DISCLOSURE TIER NDA	Who reads it. A named build partner, a customer's security reviewer, an investor in diligence. Released on a countersigned mutual NDA and not otherwise. What it says. The layer map, the boundaries, the record shape, the failure paths, the exam pack, and the split of the build. What it holds back. How the evidence store is built. An application covering that mechanism is in preparation with counsel, so it is held at this tier too, and released when counsel says so.
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1 This document in four parts

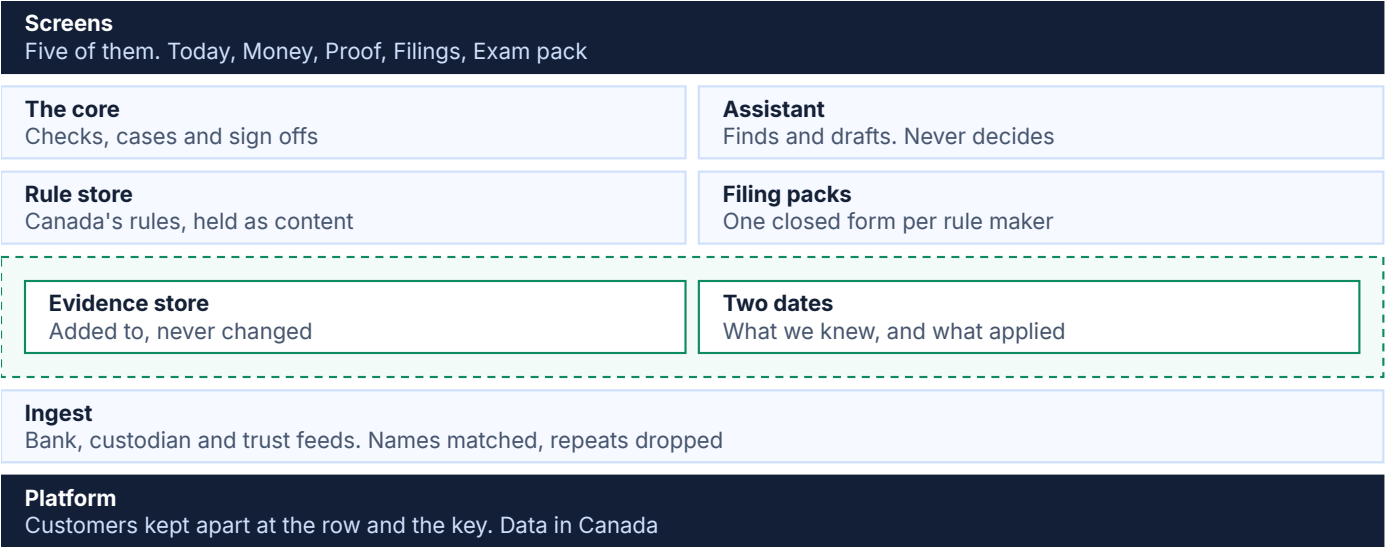


SOURCES ON THIS PAGE

Architecture Pack. Architecture Pack, 4orm Finance, 5 August 2026, the source for this document

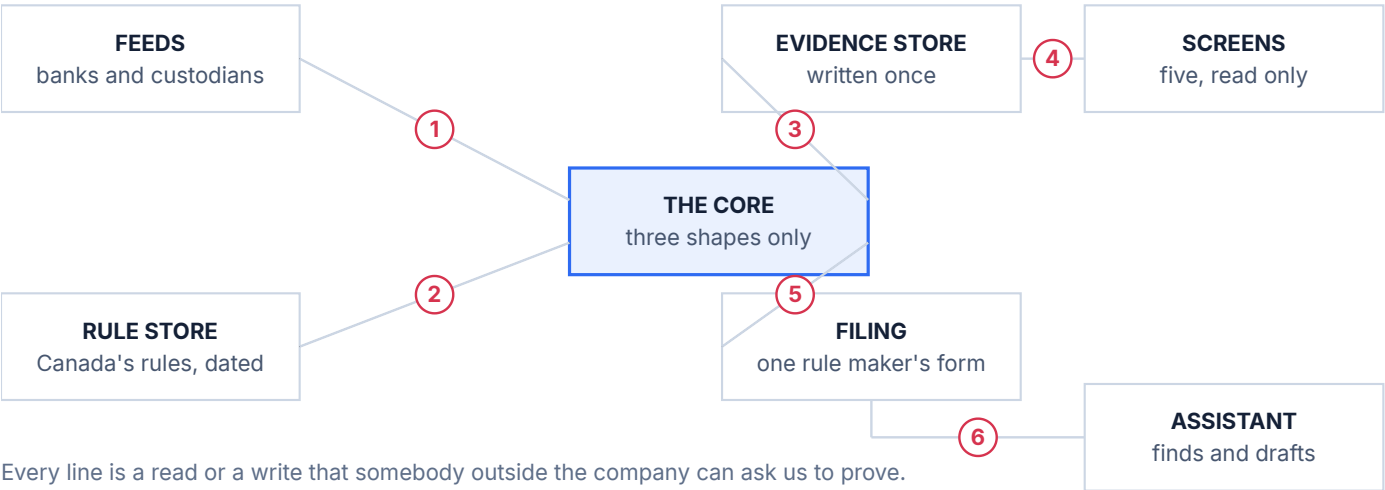
Disclosure control. Document 03.0, internal, which sets what this tier may and may not say

Nine layers, and who owns each one



Six places where two parts touch, and nowhere else

This design is set by what it refuses. The number on each gate below is the row that sets it out in the table beneath it.



Boundary	What may cross it	What must never cross it
1 Feeds into the core	A checked record with a source and the time it arrived	A value patched up on the way in. If a field will not read, the record fails rather than defaults
2 Rule store into the core	A duty, the dates it applies to, and which version was in force on the day worked	A rule written as code. If a duty cannot be written as content, the core is short a shape
3 Core into the evidence store	A whole result with its inputs, its rule version and its signer, written once	Half a write, a change, or a pointer to something that can still move
4 Evidence store into the screens	A read, logged as an event, scoped to one customer	A write of any kind. The screens never make a record, they only ask for one
5 Core into a filing	A checked payload matching the form that rule maker published for that year	A made up field carrying something the form does not accept
6 Assistant into anything	A search inside one customer, with each answer tied to a record id	A made up value entering the record. It drafts for a person and never writes proof

Legend. The right hand column matters more than the left. A design is easier to trust when it is written as a list of refusals, because the refusals are what a reviewer can test.

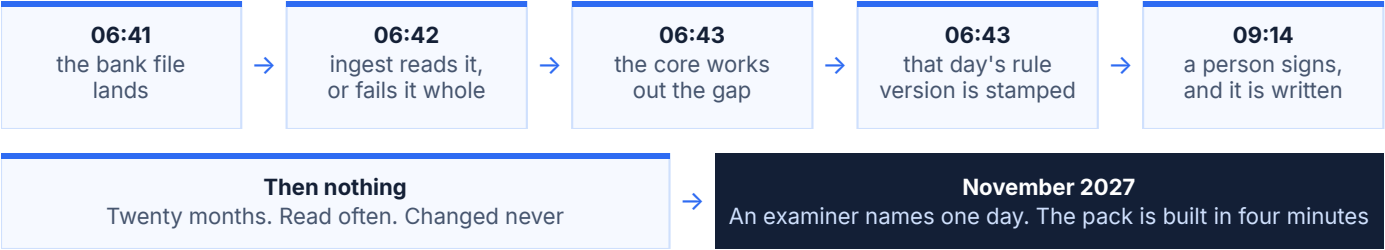
A reviewer can test the claim by asking for the seventh place. If one exists and is not on the drawing, the drawing is wrong and the design is weaker than it reads. That is a fair question to put to us in the first call.

SOURCES ON THIS PAGE

Architecture Pack. Section 6, the boundaries and the six gates

The whole life of one record

Time runs left to right. Nothing is added to the record after 09:14 on the morning it was made, and it is asked for twenty months later by somebody who was not there.



The gap between those two ends is the whole business.

A record is made in three minutes on a Tuesday morning and asked for twenty months later. Everything in this document is a choice about what may happen in the months between. The honest answer, nearly every time, is nothing at all.

2 What stops it being changed in the twenty months between

1

Written once

There is no change path and no delete path anywhere in the code, blocked by the store itself rather than by a policy above it.

2

Locked to the last

Each record is locked to the one before it, so altering one shows up in plain sight rather than being merely frowned on.

3

Proved by re-export

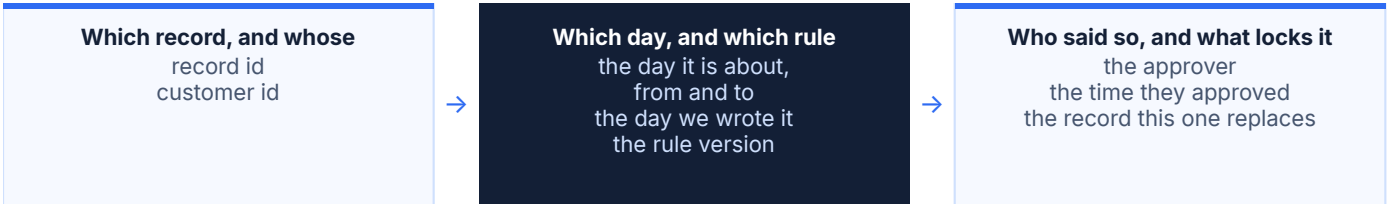
Export the month again a year later and compare. The same bytes, or the store is not add only, whatever the paperwork says.

3 The words used on the boundary table

Boundary	The line between two parts, and the only place they are allowed to touch.
Scoped	Cut down to one customer, one date range or one duty before anything is returned.
Defaults	Filling a blank with a guess. Not allowed here, at any boundary, for any reason.
Payload	The finished set of figures sent to a rule maker, in that rule maker's own form.
Record id	The label that points at one record and one record only.

The record shape, agreed before a line is written

Nine fields, grouped by the question each one answers. The middle group is the one ordinary software leaves out, and it is also the group an examiner opens with, because both of its dates are about a day that has gone.



Take one field away and a question somebody outside the company asks goes unanswered. The pair carrying the most weight is the day the record is about held together with the day we wrote it down, because holding both is what turns a database into a record.

HELD BACK ON THIS PAGE · PATENT APPLICATION IN PREPARATION

A tenth and eleventh field sit in the third group and are not named here. They are what locks each record to the one before it, and they are the shape of the claim. Also held: where the chain is anchored, how a replacing record is admitted into a store that permits no change, and how a record is serialised so two exports a year apart land on identical bytes. **An application covering this mechanism is in preparation with counsel.** It is released to a build partner on the day counsel confirms the filing, under this same NDA. Until then the build proceeds on the nine fields above, which are enough to start the platform, ingest and core work.

SOURCES ON THIS PAGE

- Architecture Pack. Section 11, the record shape
- Disclosure control. Document 03.0, held items 1 to 4

The seven things in the evidence store, and what each one carries

Thing	Made by	Carries	Sealed
Check result	The core, alone	Both totals, the gap, the shortfall answer, the list of unexplained items and the rule version	On sign off
Unexplained item	The core	The payments behind it, the likely cause, and the answer when one is written down	With its parent
Paper	A person	The written thing, its version, its owner, its signer, and the duties it answers	On sign off
Sign off	A person with the right to sign	Who, when, on what basis, and under whose authority	At once
Filing	The core, then a person	The payload as sent, the form version, the receipt, and proof of the time it was sent	On receipt
Read event	The platform	Who read what, when, from where, and under which ticket. Reads by us included	At once
Rule release	The person who owns the rules	The duty, the dates it applies to, what changed, and the signature	On release

Legend. Seven things, one store, one chain. A job is a run of steps over these seven rather than a new table, which is why the eleventh duty needs no change to the shape of the data.

A new duty adds a run of steps over these seven, never an eighth thing.

That is what keeps the eleventh job a setting rather than a build, and it is the single assumption the whole cost structure rests on.

- Check result
- Unexplained item
- Paper
- Sign off
- Filing
- Read event
- Rule release

One chain runs through all seven. A job is a run of steps over these things rather than a new table, which is what keeps the shape of the data still while the duty set grows. **Sealed** means closed and fixed at a stated moment, after which a late arrival shows up as late rather than being folded in silently. What a seal fixes, and how a late arrival is taken afterwards, is held at this tier pending the filing.

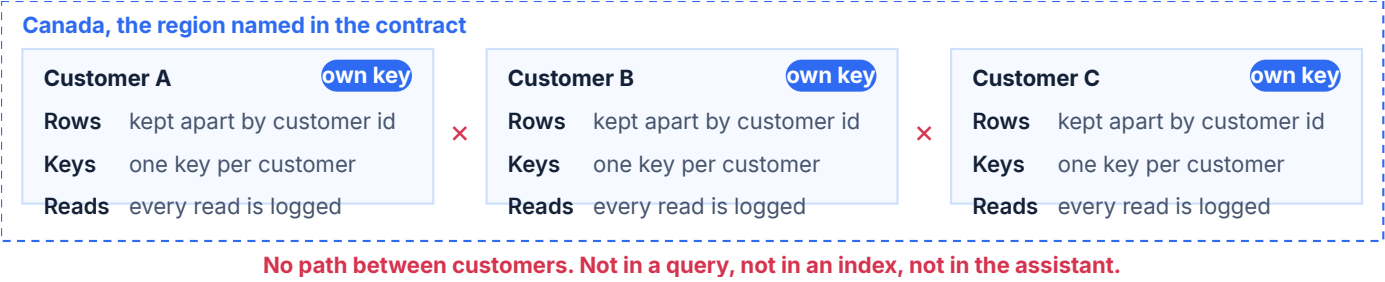
Seven things, one store, one chain, and no eighth thing.

A new duty is a run of steps over these seven. The day somebody proposes an eighth table is the day the eleventh job stops being a setting.

SOURCES ON THIS PAGE

Architecture Pack. Section 13, the seven things in the evidence store

Keeping customers apart, and where the data lives



At the row

Every record carries the customer it belongs to, and that is checked below the query rather than inside it. A badly written query cannot reach across.

At the key

One key for each customer, so one key opens one customer and no more. Wrapping and rotation are set out in the platform note.

At the read

Every read is an event with a name, a time and a ticket on it. Reads by us are logged the way reads by the customer are, and nobody holds a standing login to live data.

One core underneath, and it does not know what a payment firm is.

It knows about checks, papers with signers, and filings. Customers are kept apart below the core, at the row and at the key, so the mistake cannot be made by a bad query.

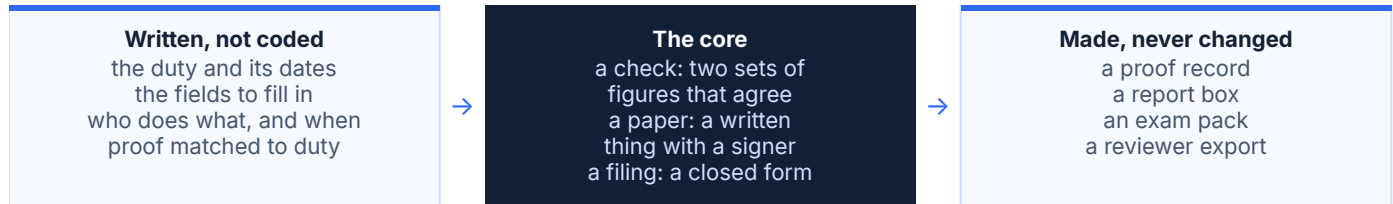
Engineers call the first of these tenant isolation and the second data residency. Ours is Canada, and it is written into the contract with the region named and the list of suppliers published. A watched buyer asks for both in the first call.

What a reviewer asks about the platform	The answer, and where it lives
Can one customer's data be reached from another customer's session?	No path exists. Not in a query, not in an index, not in the assistant. It is checked below the query rather than inside it
Does anyone at 4orm hold a standing login to live data?	Nobody, the founder included. Every read is an event with a name, a time and a ticket
Where is the data, and who else touches it?	Canada, with the region named in the contract, and every supplier named and disclosed with notice before any change
What happens to stored records if a key is swapped?	Held at this tier. It is one of the six items released when counsel confirms the filing

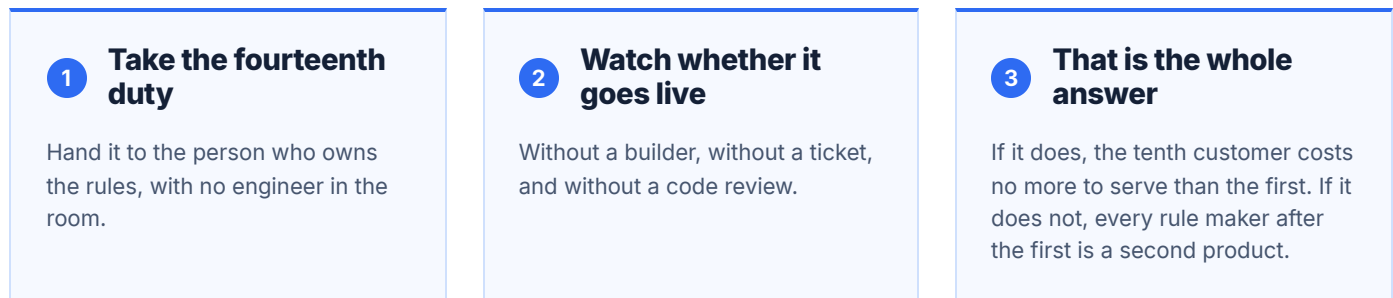
Legend. The first three are answerable in the first sales call. The fourth is the only one on this page that waits.

A new duty is a piece of writing, not a piece of code

Fourteen duties, four rule makers, three shapes. If any part of adding one needs a code release, the second rule maker costs a second build, and the money behind everything downstream changes with it.



4 The test, which is easy to run and hard to pass



5 A worked example: the second rule maker, written entirely as content

```

job: property-trust-monthly

# Alberta Real Estate Act, the monthly broker trust check
shape:      check
how often:  monthly
due:        30 days after the last statement date
sides:      client records, trust account
needs:      held per client, one line each
            client record note
signer:      broker or delegate
split duties: whoever prepares it cannot be whoever signs it
keep for:    as the rule says
links proof: check result, held per client, sign off
  
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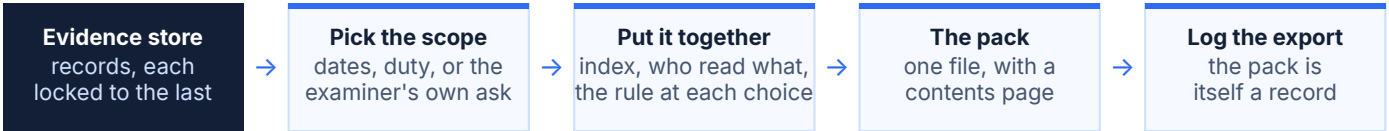
What the build team has to write to add that. Nothing. The check shape is already there. How often, when it is due and who signs are fields, not branches in code. Splitting the work from the sign off is a rule the core already keeps. This is the test of the whole idea. Run it early, on a duty chosen because it is awkward, rather than waiting for a customer to run it for us.

SOURCES ON THIS PAGE

Architecture Pack. Sections 19 and 20, the eleventh job and the worked example

The exam pack, put together rather than rebuilt

Building a pack is itself an event with a time, a scope and a name against it, so answering an examiner is recorded on the same terms as everything else in the system.



Four minutes, not three weeks.

The pack is built when it is asked for rather than kept ready, because a pack kept ready goes stale the day after it is made. The rule as it stood on each day is the part almost nothing else can produce: a duty done in March 2026 was done under the rule as it stood in March 2026, and the pack has to say so without being asked.

6 What a filing pack has to keep being able to do

Draw last year exactly as it was sent	Under last year's form, three years from now, after the form has changed twice.
Show the trail from each figure	Back to the record that made it, in one click, without a person reassembling it.
Prove when it was sent	Without leaning on our own clock, and keeping the rule maker's receipt as a record.
Live through a mid year change	To the form, without spoiling anything already sent under the earlier version.
Take a refusal as a record	Keep it, try again on a clock, and never reshape the payload to make it pass.

What is in a filing pack

- The map from our record shape to the rule maker's form, written as content.
- The checks, run before sending and never after, with the failure shown against the duty.
- The way it is sent, whether a portal or an upload, and how we prove who we are.
- The receipt, the retry rule and the failure handling.

Why it is under counted

- The form is short, so the work looks small. The form is the easy half.
- The hard half is drawing last year exactly as it was sent, three years from now.
- A filing that fails at 23:50 on 31 March is the case that matters.
- One pack per rule maker, per year, and each one has to keep working.

The pack is itself a record.

Making one is an event with a time, a scope and a name against it, so answering an examiner is written down on the same terms as everything else in the system.

SOURCES ON THIS PAGE

Architecture Pack. Sections 23 and 24, the exam pack and the filing pack

Four things that have to be right in the first release

None of these four is dear at the start. All four are close to out of reach at the end, which is the whole case for spending the first release on the layers nobody can see.

Thing	Cost now	What adding it later means	The test
Add only store	Days	Each record written before the change has nothing behind it, so the trail is provable only from the day the change shipped. The oldest and most examined records are the ones left bare	The same bytes on a second export
Two dates	One to two weeks	The rule versions that applied to past choices were never kept, so they cannot be worked out from anything. The system can say what it believes now, which is not the question	Run any day again, get the same answer
Rules as content	Two to three weeks	Rules already in code have to be pulled out of it and every customer moved. In practice this gets put off, and the layer becomes a set of one off builds	Ship a duty with no code release
Customers apart at the key	Days, if designed in	Adding it later means re-keying live customer data. It is the most likely place for a breach to be let in, and it would be let in by the fix	A cross customer read returns nothing

Legend. Cost now is engineering time in the first release. The test column is what a reviewer should ask to see running, rather than described.

7 Three ways these get dropped, in order of how likely they are

1 A demonstration date

The screens are seen and the store is not. When a date moves, the work nobody can see is what gets traded, and nobody in the room feels they have lost anything.

2 A support call

A customer has a wrong value and wants it fixed rather than replaced. One admin change, granted once, under pressure, ends the add only claim for good.

3 A sensible engineer

Dating each rule version looks like too much to somebody who has never sat in an examination. The case for it is a rule case rather than a build case, which is exactly why it is written down here.

Build the two hardest things first, because they are the two that cannot be added later.

Both are invisible on a demonstration, and both are the whole reason a watched buyer would trust us with the record they will be examined on.

SOURCES ON THIS PAGE

Architecture Pack. Sections 14 and 15, the four things and the cost of each

Twelve questions for the architect, in the order they matter

The first six are about the record and the store. The second six are about rules, failure and proof. A good answer names a thing, not a wish, and says where that thing lives.

#	Question	What a good answer sounds like
1	Where does add only actually live?	In the store, in the application, or in a habit. Name the thing, not the wish
2	How would you hold the two dates?	Two date pairs on the row, a history table, or a built in feature. Each has a different cost to run a day again
3	What does a fix look like?	Show the write path for a value fixed six weeks later, and what the first reader sees afterwards
4	How is the chain anchored?	Per customer, per month, or one for all. And what stops a chain being rebuilt whole
5	Where are customers kept apart?	If the answer has the word query in it, we should talk before anything is written
6	How are keys split per customer?	Wrapped keys, a key tree, and what happens when a key is swapped
7	What reads a job written as content?	The thing that turns writing into a running duty is the least showy part here, and the one that decides the whole idea
8	How do you run history again after a rule change?	Run again and show the difference, or run again and restate. Only the first is acceptable
9	What does the ingest failure path look like?	Say what happens to a file that half reads
10	How do you test that nothing can be changed?	A line in a document is not a test. What runs on every code change?
11	What is the export form?	It has to be readable without us, and the same bytes when exported again a year later
12	What would you push back on here?	The most useful answer on the list. If nothing here is worth arguing with, it has not been read closely

Legend. Questions 4 and 6 touch held material. A build partner answering them is telling us how they would do it, which is what we want to hear before we tell them how we do.

The last question on the list matters most.

A pack nobody argues with has not been read closely. We would rather hear an objection to the anchoring choice in week one than discover in month nine that the partner never had a view.

SOURCES ON THIS PAGE

Architecture Pack. Section 28, the twelve questions for the architect

What is held at this tier, and how to get it

Held	Released when	Released to
The fingerprint fields, and the pairing that locks each record to the last	Counsel confirms the filing date	A named build partner, under this NDA
Where the chain is anchored, and how often	Counsel confirms the filing date	A named build partner, under this NDA
How a correction is admitted without breaking the lock behind it	Not scheduled. Trade secret	Named engineers inside 4orm Finance
How a record is serialised so two exports land on the same bytes	Not scheduled. Trade secret	Named engineers inside 4orm Finance
What a seal fixes, and how a late arrival is taken after it	Not scheduled. Trade secret	Named engineers inside 4orm Finance
How one key for each customer sits underneath the chain	Not scheduled. Trade secret	Named engineers inside 4orm Finance

Legend. A build partner can start the platform, ingest, core and screen work today without any of the six. The two layers that need them are built in house, by senior hands, and are finished before the first screen is drawn.

8 What this document does not prove

It is a design, not a running system	What exists today is the design, the duty analysis and the build agreement. A reviewer should ask what is running before treating any of it as shipped.
The hardest claim needs a year to demonstrate	Two exports of the same month, a year apart, cannot be shown until a year of records exists. Until then it is an automatic check inside the build and a commitment here.
The second rule maker is tested at gate three	One build carrying a provincial trust duty alongside the federal one is the commercial case, and it is a claim until that gate is passed.

Read more, and read less

03.1 Technology Overview is the open tier version of this document, safe to forward to anybody without a signature. **03.0 Disclosure Control** is the internal sheet that decides what each tier may say.

SOURCES ON THIS PAGE

Disclosure control. Document 03.0, internal, the held list and the tier rules
Architecture Pack. Architecture Pack, 4orm Finance, 5 August 2026, the source for this document